

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

POLICY MANUAL

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PURPOSE

1. To reduce the level of firefighter injury and mortality.
2. To ensure the Department's ability to track the location and status of all personnel engaged in emergency operations through an effective Personnel Accountability System (PAS.)
3. To ensure compliance with the "Two-In/Two Out" rule established by the National Fire Protection Association (NFPA), and adopted by the Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) and the California Occupational Safety and Health Administration (Cal/OSHA).
4. To ensure immediate assistance for personnel who become lost, trapped or injured during the course of emergency operations by providing Standby Personnel and, as needed, Rapid Intervention Crews at all incidents where personnel are working in conditions that are Immediately Dangerous to Life or Health (IDLH).
5. To ensure a departmental standard of notifying the Incident Commander and all operating units that a "Fire Fighter Down" situation is occurring.
6. To ensure a departmental standard outlining basic survival technique for lost, trapped or injured firefighters.

SCOPE

This instruction applies to all IDLH Incident Responders.

Authority: The Department's Firefighter Safety and Accountability policy has as its basis OSHA and Cal/OSHA regulations (29 CFR Parts 1910 and 1926: Title 8. Section 5144. Respiratory Protection Standards).

The guidelines establish an Accountability System and Rapid Intervention Crews whenever employees are exposed to IDLH conditions.

Although the legal application of these rules revolves around "interior structural firefighting while the building is burning", the concept of standby Rapid Intervention Crews is also extended to other high-risk incidents (see definitions IDLH), to improve the safety of our personnel.

RESPONSIBILITY

1. All Incident Commanders will be responsible for:
 - a. Maintaining a Personnel Accountability System (PAS) at every IDLH Incident, based on Unity of Command and Company Unity.
 - b. A written Personnel Accountability Roster will be used at all working incidents under IDLH conditions.
 - c. Ensuring compliance with the "Two In/Two Out "Rule established by the NFPA, OSHA, and Cal/OSHA.

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- d. Establishing at least one Standby Crew on all IDLH incidents.
 - i. The Standby Crew will be replaced by or converted to a Rapid Intervention Crew (RIC) whenever an incident expands in size or complexity that includes an Incident Commander's request for additional resources beyond the first alarm assignment. (Nothing precludes individual companies from establishing a RIC as a standard response on the first alarm.)
 - e. Immediately implementing Rapid Intervention operations whenever a "Fire Fighter Down" situation is reported.
 - f. Developing an Incident Action Plan (IAP) and formulating strategic priorities in accordance with this instruction and other Department Policies.
 - g. Demobilization of the Rapid Intervention Crew when personnel are no longer exposed to IDLH conditions.
 - h. Ensuring all appropriate incident documentation is filed at Department Headquarters and forwarded to the Fire Chief whenever a fire ground emergency (Firefighter Down I Injury from fire behavior) occurs. The documentation will include an Investigation Report, the Incident Action Plan (IAP) call history and PAS Roster information.
2. All Operations Section Chiefs (Ops.), Branch Directors, Division/Group Supervisors, and other incident supervisors/overhead personnel are responsible for:
- a. Maintaining Personnel Accountability within their assigned Branches, Divisions, Groups, and Units.
 - b. Ensuring compliance with the "Two In/Two Out" Rule, within their area of responsibility.
 - c. Ensuring that Rapid Intervention capabilities are appropriate for the level of IDLH hazards within their area of responsibility.
 - d. Immediately notifying the Incident Commander of any reported "Fire Fighter Down" situations within their area of responsibility.
3. All Company Officers are responsible for:
- a. Maintaining Company Unity and Personnel Accountability. This includes keeping the Incident Commander, Ops, or their assigned Division or Group Supervisor, informed about the location and status of their Company.
 - b. Maintaining the names of assigned crewmembers in the cab of each responding unit under their command. (See Appendix A)
 - c. Complying with the "Two In/Two Out" Rule.
 - d. Notifying the Incident Commander or other assigned supervisor of any "Fire Fighter Down" situation, performing an immediate accounting of their company or assigned resources when ordered, and being prepared to assist with a Rapid Intervention operation as assigned.

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4. All personnel will be responsible for:
 - a. Maintaining Unity of Command and keeping their supervisor informed of their location and status at all times while on the emergency scene. Personnel assigned to single units without an officer on board (i.e. water tender, personnel responding in private vehicles) will report to staging or in its absence, the Incident Commander and remain under the supervision of an appropriate officer.
 - b. Complying with the "Two In/Two Out" Rule.
 - c. Notifying their supervisor of any "Fire Fighter Down" situation, and being prepared to assist with a Rapid Intervention Operation as assigned.
 - d. Being familiar with basic survival techniques when lost, trapped or injured at an emergency scene.
5. All personnel assigned to a Standby Crew or Rapid Intervention Crew(s) will be responsible for remaining in a full state of readiness to conduct a Rapid Intervention Operation whenever a "Fire Fighter Down" situation is reported.
6. Riverside Unit ECC Personnel are responsible for supporting radio communications during emergency operations.

POLICY

1. Personnel Accountability
 - a. A Personnel Accountability System will be established at every working emergency, based on strict adherence to Unity of Command and Company Unity.
 - b. A written Personnel Accountability System Roster (PAS Roster) will be maintained at all IDLH incidents. Copies of the PAS Roster will be stored with other tactical worksheets on all Department command vehicles (including engines/trucks etc.).
2. The "Two In/Two Out" Rule
 - a. The "Two in/Two Out" Rule will be adhered to.
 - i. The Incident Commander and other Company Officers must determine whether IDLH conditions exist at every incident. If IDLH conditions are found, the Incident Commander or Company Officer will ensure that at least one two-person Standby Crew is in place, before committing personnel into the hazardous area.
 - ii. The only allowable exception occurs when the Incident Commander or Company Officer determines that there is an imminent life-threatening situation, where immediate action could prevent the loss of life or serious injury. No exception will be permitted when there is no possibility to save lives.
 - iii. In these exceptional cases, a Standby Crew will be established immediately upon the arrival of sufficient resources. When this "life-saving emergency rescue." exception is invoked, the circumstances must be investigated and documented "with a written report submitted to the Fire Chief".

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3. Rapid Intervention Crews

- a. The Incident Commander will designate at least one two-person crew (preferably an engine company) as a RIC whenever an incident expands in size or complexity that includes an Incident Commander's request for additional resources beyond the first alarm assignment.
- b. This includes interior structure fires, confined space rescues, building collapses, trench collapses, tunnel fires, high rise fires and other IDLH incidents.
- c. When available, a Technical Rescue Company will respond on Second Alarm responses for commercial fires, residential fires, high-rise fires and other high-risk incidents that require the presence of Rapid Intervention Crews. A truck company or other appropriate resource may be substituted as necessary.
- d. Consideration will be given to the potential rescue problem of an incident and a matching of Crew I equipment capability (i.e. medium I heavy rescue-collapse operations.)
- e. The term "Fire Fighter Down"
 - i. Will be used to notify the Incident Commander, Fire Emergency Communications Center (ECC) and all on-scene companies that a member is lost, trapped or seriously injured and requires immediate assistance.
- f. The term "Emergency Traffic"
 - i. Will be used to clear radio traffic.
 - ii. Fire ECC will then transmit 3 short alert tones and repeat "Emergency Traffic" followed by a concise, clear text, description of the emergency (i.e. Operational Retreat/Firefighter Down).
 - iii. All radio traffic will cease on any channel where emergency traffic has been requested unless directly related to the "Emergency Traffic" situation.
 - iv. At the conclusion of the "Emergency Traffic" situation, the Incident Commander will transmit "All Clear, Resume Radio Traffic" to put an end to the emergency situation and ensure the ECC is notified.
 - v. ECC will transmit 2 short alert tones and announce "all clear" on the command channels.
- g. Multiple RIC's will be established and combined into a Rapid Intervention Group when;
 - i. It is determined that a single RIC cannot provide immediate intervention to all parts of the incident.
- h. All crews entering a hazardous area must possess a portable radio.
 - i. If a radio fails while in an IDLH situation, the crew will exit the hazard area unless there is another working radio with the crew. Minimum crew size is two and entry crewmembers will be in communication with each other through visual, audible or physical means which may include a safety guide rope.

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- i. The Incident Commander will demobilize, downgrade, release, or reassign the RIC when personnel are no longer operating in IDLH situations.
- j. Outside automatic or mutual aid agencies will be trained and continually updated in regards to all instructions listed in this document.

PROCEDURES

1. Personnel Accountability System (PAS)

- a. The Incident Commander will establish the Personnel Accountability System through the exercise of Company Controls, including Company Unity and Unity of Command.
- b. The Incident Commander or designee will prepare a written Incident Personnel Roster whenever personnel are working within the IDLH operational area.
 - i. On Complex incidents, the Incident Commander should initiate periodic Personnel Accountability Reports
 - ii. A PAR is used to verify and update the Personnel Accountability System Roster (PAS Roster). A PAR should be conducted for the following incident conditions:
 - 1. Any report of a missing, trapped or seriously injured member. Any change from offensive to defensive operations. Any sudden hazardous event at the incident. (i.e. collapse, flashover, back draft, etc.).
 - 2. Any other time that the Incident Commander requires.
- c. Operations Section Chiefs, Branch Directors, Division/Group Supervisors and other overhead will maintain a constant awareness of the location and status of all companies and units within their assigned areas of responsibility. Overhead personnel should be prepared to provide PAR information upon request by the Incident Commander.
- d. Company Officers will maintain constant awareness of the location and status of personnel assigned to them, just as members will remain aware of the status and location of their supervisor.
- e. All members will ensure that their supervisor is aware of their location and status at all times. "Freelancing" by individuals or crews will not be permitted.
- f. The Incident Commander or designee will maintain a written Personnel Accountability System Roster at the scene of an IDLH incident.
 - i. The Incident Commander will record the names of all members assigned from staging to a branch, division or group on the Personnel Accountability System Roster (PAS Roster).
 - ii. The PAS Roster will include the unit designator, the last names of assigned personnel, the unit's assignment and the crew's time of entry I exit into or out of the hazardous area.
 - iii. Upon completion of their assignment, entry crews will check out with the Incident Commander or designee to update to the PAS Roster.

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2. All initial response crew leaders will receive an Incident Command based assignment as they check in with the Incident Commander for the PAS Roster.
3. All personnel checking into the incident will be recorded on the PAS Roster in order to maintain total scene accountability.
4. As required by the California F.I.R.E.S.C.O.P.E. ICS document 910; "total scene" personnel accountability must be maintained and documented.
 - i. This will be accomplished through:
 1. The use of the Personal Accountability System roster for personnel assigned from the Incident Commander to incident operations;
 2. The documentation of personnel responding on individual units.
 3. This will be accomplished through the use of the Personnel Accountability System Equipment Roster (Appendix A) to be posted in a conspicuous location adjacent to the apparatus operator seating position.
 4. The crew leader will maintain a list of personnel responding on that unit and the list will be continuously updated.
 5. It will be the crew leader's responsibility to ensure as a part of the daily check that all units under his/her command have updated PAS Equipment Roster with the assigned personnel. Each responding unit from a particular station will maintain an accountability form as described.
 6. Upon the request of a PAR, incident personnel will be accounted for using these three sources:
 - a. PAS Roster
 - b. Staging I Incident Command records of personnel responding in private vehicles
 - c. PAS Equipment Roster accountability forms. Note: If necessary, the Incident Commander may designate a runner and/or accountability officer to collect accountability information from each apparatus cab.
5. Marking and Identification of Structure Helmets, each member is individually responsible for maintaining the correct magnetic helmet unit designator that represents their current unit assignment. This is essential to avoid confusion on incidents and/or assist in establishing an accurate PAR during an Operational Retreat.
6. An Operational Retreat is defined as an evacuation of all personnel operating in hazardous areas at an emergency incident.
 - a. The operational retreat may be prompted by various situations including imminent safety hazards or a switch from an offensive to defensive attack.
 - b. Its purpose is to remove crews to safety and to obtain an accurate PAR of on scene members.

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- c. In addition withdrawal may be the only way to quickly obtain accurate information on the location of trapped/injured members the route to them and the type of rescue equipment needed.
 - d. An Operational Retreat is normally initiated by the Incident Commander but may be initiated by Division/Group Supervisors and above when imminent hazards exist.
 - e. Personnel should not slow their departure from the hazard area to reclaim tools, hose lines etc. Company unity will be maintained throughout the retreat to a safe zone.
 - f. Each crew should proceed to the nearest exit point and return to their point of entry to a safe zone located a minimum distance of 1% times the height of the structure.
 - g. Requesting "Emergency Traffic" from the Incident Commander and requesting an Operational Retreat will initiate the Evacuation Signal.
 - h. The ECC will notify on scene personnel of the Operational Retreat by activating 3 alert tones. The alert tones will be followed by an ECC broadcast on Command Channels and by the Incident Commander on Tactical Channels.
 - i. In addition, an on scene evacuation signal will consist of repeated short blasts of the air horn for approximately 10 seconds, followed by 10 seconds of silence. This sequence of air horn blasts for 10 seconds followed by a 10 second period of silence will be done three times. Total air horn evacuation signal including periods of silence will last 50 seconds. (FIREScope 910- VI. B.)
 - j. When a PAR is initiated, all personnel will immediately report their location and status to their supervisors. An immediate location and status report including the specific names of personnel will be forwarded to the appropriate ICS supervisor.
 - k. The accountability information will be forwarded to the person responsible for the PAS Roster when requested.
 - l. When the PAR is complete, the information will be routed directly to the Operations Chief or Incident Commander as appropriate. If any personnel or companies are unaccounted for, the Incident Commander will order a repeated PAR; send a runner to verify the PAR if radio problems are suspected, and/or institute a Rapid Intervention Operation as needed.
7. Incident Time Notification: Upon the request from the initial Incident Commander the Unit ECC will start an incident clock when the first unit arrives on scene of a working IDLH incident that appears to be time sensitive or hazardous. (FIREScope ICS 910)
- a. At each 15-minute interval, Unit ECC will advise the Incident Commander of the elapsed time on the incident clock until the Incident Commander requests cancellation. For example, the announcement from the Unit ECC may be phrased: " Incident Commander from Unit ECC, the time 15 (30, 45, 60, etc.) Minutes on the incident clock."

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- b. The ECC will continue to advise the Incident Commander of the elapsed time at each additional 15-minute interval, or until canceled by the Incident Commander or until the incident is declared under control, i.e. knockdown.
- 8. "Two in/Two Out" Rule Procedures:
 - a. OSHA defines an incipient stage fire as one "which is in the initial or beginning stage and which can be controlled or extinguished by portable fire extinguishers, class II standpipe or small hose systems without the need for protective clothing or breathing apparatus." Any structural fire beyond the incipient stage is considered to be an IDLH atmosphere by OSHA.
 - b. Conditions present during an advanced structural fire create an IDLH atmosphere and will be subject to the "Two In/Two Out" Rule.
 - c. Personnel operating in hazardous or IDLH conditions will operate in teams of two or more.
 - d. These crews will be equipped with SCBA and other appropriate Personal Protective Equipment based on the hazards at the incident scene.
 - e. These crewmembers will be in communication with each other through visual, voice, physical, or tag line methods in order to coordinate their activities.
 - f. Communications between crewmembers should not rely strictly on radio use due to the potential for radio failure. Therefore, all crewmembers must be equipped with tag lines and remain in close proximity to each other.
 - i. Note: tag lines will not be used as life-safety lines or otherwise support human weight under any circumstance, communication and navigation aid in IDLH atmospheres, and gear. Appropriate tag line use includes: accountability, hauling (vertical & horizontal).
 - g. Upon arrival of the first company, the Incident Commander will designate no less than two members to act as a Standby Crew.
 - h. This crew will be assigned to "standby" outside of the hazardous area to provide immediate assistance to entry crewmembers if the need arises.
 - i. Based on Cal OSHA Title 8-5144 (g)(4)(Note 2) and NFPA 1500, the only exception to the "Two In/Two Out" Rule will be permitted when the first arriving personnel determine that there is an:
 - 1. Emergency Rescue I imminent life-threatening situation.
 - 2. Where immediate action could prevent the loss of life or serious injury.
 - 3. Unless this exceptional situation is encountered, entry into the hazardous area will require at least four personnel on the scene (i.e. "Two In/Two Out").
 - 4. Suppression crews arriving for initial attack with less than four personnel will immediately determine whether there is an imminent threat to life that may be mitigated only if members are immediately committed to operate within the hazardous area.

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5. Unless such a situation exists, these units will await the arrival of additional resources (with sufficient personnel to establish a two-person Standby Crew) before committing personnel into the hazardous area.
6. Numerous exterior operations can be performed while waiting for the arrival of additional resources.
 - a. Examples include performing a 360° survey, securing utilities, setting ladders/fans, deploying hose lines and performing exterior fire attack.
7. If it has been determined that immediate commitment into the hazardous area is necessary to prevent loss of life or serious injuries, the on-scene personnel may do so (as allowed under the Exception rule in OSHA [29 CFR 1910 134(g) (4) (Note 2)]).
8. Personnel entering a hazard area for a known rescue prior to four members being on scene will notify the Incident Commander or ECC of their impending entry.
9. Upon completion of the incident, the Incident Commander will document the situation and conditions that led to any deviation from the "Two In/ Two out" Rule.
10. The documentation will be recorded on in the CAIRS Incident Report. The narrative section should provide findings, including details of the rescue, safety procedures in place at the time of the rescue and the status of the persons rescued. A summary of incident times will also be included (i.e. CAD printout).
11. The Incident Commander (Chief Officer) will be responsible to investigate the deviation from the Two In/Two Out Rule. The Chief Officer will also ensure reports are completed to standard and routed to the Fire Chief.
12. In accordance with Cal OSHA Regulation [Title 8 I 5144 (g) (4) (Note 1)], only one member of a two-person Standby Crew may be permitted to perform other duties such as apparatus operator, Incident Commander or Safety Officer. However, this individual may perform another task only if he/she can leave that position to respond into the hazardous area without jeopardizing other fire fighters. This may necessitate that the first-in officer pass command to participate as a member of the entry crew or delay commitment of the first interior entry team until additional resources arrive.
13. At all high rise IDLH incidents; a minimum of four personnel will be assigned to initial attack. Two members of this group will be identified as the Entry Crew and the other two members will be identified as the Standby Crew.

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- a. The Standby Crew will remain in the safe atmosphere of the stairwell while the Entry Crew enters the hazardous area. The Incident Commander will assign at least one company as the RIC upon the arrival of resources beyond the 1st alarm.
 - b. The Incident Commander will designate at least one RIC to the appropriate stairwell of each fire floor from which fire attack and search and rescue operations are to be conducted.
 - 14. A wide variety of other high risk emergency incident types may also fall under the category of IDLH (Immediately Dangerous to Life and Health), and are also subject to the "Two In/Two Out " Rule.
 - 15. At Confined Space Rescues, the Incident Commander will designate at least one 2-person RIC consisting of personnel certified to the Confined Space Technical Level, or if unavailable, Confined Space Awareness Level.
 - 16. At trench rescues, structural collapses, excavation rescues, and other situations with the potential for collapse, engulfment, and other similar hazards, the Incident Commander should designate at least two certified Technical Rescue Specialists as the RIC when available.
 - 17. At hazardous materials IDLH incidents, the Incident Commander will designate at least one RIC.
9. Rapid Intervention Crews Procedures:
- a. A Rapid Intervention Crew (RIC) will be assigned whenever an IDLH incident expands in size or complexity that includes an Incident Commander 's request for additional resources beyond the first alarm assignment.
 - b. The RIC may be involved in limited operations pertaining to firefighter safety (i.e. placing firefighter egress ladders) provided it remains immediately available for firefighter rescue.
 - c. One Technical Rescue Company (medium capability or higher) will automatically be dispatched via mutual aid request for all Second Alarm incidents (except wild land fires). If Technical Rescue companies are not available, Unit ECC may substitute a truck company or other appropriate resource.
 - d. As the incident progresses, the Incident Commander /Operations will evaluate the Rapid Intervention Crew and upgrade or create multiple RIC's as necessary to meet worsening conditions, newly discovered hazards or incidents which grow too large to be covered by only one RIC. Multiple RIC's can be organized into a Rapid Intervention Group for ICS organizational purposes.

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- e. RIC Readiness: Upon assignment to a Rapid Intervention Crew members will report to a position near the Command Post or other area designated by the Incident Commander in a full state of readiness. The RIC Supervisor will report to the Incident Commander (or Ops. if established) to review current conditions, known hazards, locations of committed personnel and units, the Incident Action Plan and potential Rapid Intervention Plans. The RIC Supervisor will evaluate the current capabilities of the RIC to match on-scene conditions (i.e. specialized equipment/personnel)
- f. Personnel Accountability System Roster: Unless directed otherwise by the Incident Commander, the responsibility of maintaining the PAS Roster will remain with the Incident Commander. Preparation of an accurate PAS Roster will contribute to RIC effectiveness through the knowledge of entry personnel locations and assignments. The PAS Roster will be continuously updated as crews move into and out of the hazardous area.
- g. RIC Briefing: The RIC Supervisor will provide a briefing to the crew members identifying current conditions, known hazards, the locations of committed personnel and units, and tentative RIC Plans of Action in response to potential "Fire Fighter Down" situations.
- h. RIC Equipment Pool: The RIC will establish an equipment pool based on the hazards and RIC situations that are most likely to be encountered at the incident. The equipment pool will be located for rapid use if a rapid intervention operation is required. The following is a guideline for RIC equipment.
- i. For fires, each member of the Rapid Intervention Crew will possess:
 - i. Full Protective Personal Equipment, with SCBA and PASS
 - ii. Two Flashlights
 - iii. Forcible entry tools for escape (halogen tool, flat head axe) search rope, tag line (rope bag)
 - iv. Spare batteries
 - v. Thermal Imager with spare battery (if company equipped)
 - vi. Pre-assembled high rise kit (as needed)
 - vii. RIC Pac or spare complete SCBA
- j. High Rise fires, Rapid Intervention Crew will possess:
 - i. Full Protective Personal Equipment, with SCBA and PASS
 - ii. Forcible entry tools for escape (halogen tool, flat head axe) with two pulling tools
 - iii. Two flash lights
 - iv. Spare HT Batteries
 - v. Pre-Assembled High-Rise Kit
 - vi. Spare SCBA cylinder for every company member
 - vii. Thermal Imager with spare battery (if the company is equipped)
 - viii. 2 PPV Fans
- k. For fires, each Rapid Intervention Crew will possess:

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- i. One charged hose line.
 - ii. One portable radio
 - l. RIC Equipment suggested for fires in Wood Frame/Heavy Timber/Ordinary construction may include: Spare SCBA's, pick head axes, pike poles, circular wood blade saw, ventilation chain saw, sledge hammer, halogen bar or other similar tool, ground ladders as necessary, access to aerial ladders as necessary, and air bags/shoring/cribbing, if collapse hazard.
 - m. RIC Equipment suggested for fires in Noncombustible/Fire Resistive construction may include: Spare SCBA's, halogen bars or other similar tools, sledge hammers, circular metal-blade saw, circular dry cut concrete-blade saw as necessary, torch, air bags/shoring/cribbing, if collapse hazard, ground ladders as necessary, access to aerial ladders as necessary.
 - n. RIC Equipment suggested for collapse operations: Spare SCBA's, airbags, shoring and cribbing, air knife/air vacuum as necessary, submersible pump as necessary, torches and cutting saws, fiber optic scopes, search cameras, thermal imaging when available, or other equipment based on hazards.
 - o. RIC Equipment for other high-risk incident types: should be based on the particular hazards, as recommended by technical specialists and as required by law (e.g. intrinsically safe equipment for confined space operations)
 - p. Automatic Aid/Mutual Aid: When responding with an outside agency into their jurisdictional area, our personnel will provide an outside standby crew for our own personnel, unless they have ensured that a standby crew is being provided by the outside agency. When an outside agency is responding into our jurisdiction, the Incident Commander will ensure this outside resource is capable of performing Standby Crew I RIC duties according to this standard prior to receiving that assignment.
10. "Fire Fighter Down" Procedures:
- a. Any personnel who become aware that a member is seriously injured, trapped, lost, or in need of other immediate life-saving assistance, will immediately initiate or ensure that a "Fire Fighter Down" notification is made.
 - b. Request "Emergency Traffic" from the Incident Commander on the Command and/or Tactical channel and state: "Fire Fighter Down!"
 - c. Once radio traffic has been cleared by the Unit ECC (3 alert tones) followed by an announcement, the individual reporting the "Fire Fighter Down" condition will provide as much information as possible about the nature of the situation, including the following types of information:
 - i. The identification of the member(s) and company involved.
 - ii. The number of personnel affected.
 - iii. An accurate location of the "Fire Fighter Down" situation.
 - iv. A brief description of the situation and any special equipment or capabilities required finding or rescuing the affected personnel.

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- v. An assessment of whether the member or company can assist in their own rescue and the best avenues of travel to reach the "Fire Fighter Down" site.
- vi. Whether it is safe to enter the hazard area or any special hazards to personnel attempting to assist.
- vii. Upon notification of a Firefighter Down situation, the radio frequency used for relaying information about the trapped member/crew will remain clear for that purpose. All other fire ground personnel will switch to a designated secondary tactical frequency to continue fire ground operations.
- viii. If unable to contact the Incident Commander the member will notify Unit ECC on the command channel and the information will be relayed to the Incident Commander.
- ix. Based on the Incident Commander 's rapid intervention plan, the member or company will be directed to take whatever immediate action is necessary to safely begin a search and rescue operation. The Rapid Intervention Crew will augment this operation.
- x. Rapid Intervention Crew operations will begin immediately thereafter. Personnel and units that are performing critical operations (i.e. fire fighting and exposure protection in support of the Rapid Intervention efforts or other life-safety need, etc.) WILL continue those efforts, unless conditions become untenable.
- xi. Upon receiving a report of a "Fire Fighter Down" emergency situation, the Incident Commander will assign the Rapid Intervention Crew to begin search and rescue operations and notify Unit ECC of the situation.
- xii. The ECC, upon receiving a report of a "Fire Fighter Down" condition, will immediately clear the command channel of all but "Emergency Traffic" and broadcast a "Firefighter Down" notification to all units operating on the incident. Unit ECC will assign a separate Tactical Frequency for normal fire ground operations. The initial Tactical Frequency will only be used for communications between the RIC and the downed firefighter(s).
- xiii. The Operations Section Chief, Division/Group Supervisors, Company Officers, and other on-scene supervisors, upon receiving notification of a "Fire Fighter Down" emergency, will immediately conduct a PAR to account for all personnel under their command and report any missing personnel to the Incident Commander or designee responsible for the PAS Roster when the information is requested. They will then make an assessment of their current situation and resources with respect to the ability to provide augmentation resources to assist with the Rapid Intervention Crew operation.
- xiv. The Incident Commander/Operations will confer with the RIC to determine if additional resources are needed, and establish a Rapid

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Intervention Plan. A secondary RIC will be established upon the entry of the primary RIC.

- xv. Upon "Fire Fighter Down" notification, the Incident Commander should consider addressing more resources to assist in mitigating the situation.
- xvi. Companies that are not engaged in critical operations will be made immediately available to the Rapid Intervention Crew/Group via the Incident Commander /Operations/Staging.
- xvii. Upon entry into the area to be searched Rapid Intervention Crew(s) will remain in working teams of two or more. Direct rescue efforts will continue as the safety of the scene dictates
- xviii. When searching for lost, trapped or injured members rescue crews should consider the following:
 - 1. Tracing attack hose lines into the collapse area.
 - 2. Tracing tag lines into the area.
 - 3. Surveying for evidence of building locations that were described by lost firefighters
 - 4. Searching for flashlight beams.
 - 5. Opening or unlocking all doors.
 - 6. Searching the immediate area of the doorway first.
 - 7. Searching hallways before interior rooms.
 - 8. Searching exterior walls (interior sides) before searching interior spaces.
 - 9. Searching large interior spaces in a detailed grid pattern.
 - 10. Ensuring all areas are searched.
 - 11. Clearly marking searched areas (FIREScope USAR marking system) to eliminate duplication of efforts.
 - 12. Using tag lines when searching "off hose line" to ensure safety of rescuers.
 - 13. Although the primary means of communication between interior and exterior crews is by portable radio, an alternate method may include the use of a rope tag line and the following acronym.
 - 14. OATH
 - a. O = O.K. One tug on rope
 - b. A = Advance Two tugs on rope
 - c. T = Take up slack Three tugs on rope
 - d. H = Help Four tugs on rope
 - 15. The RIC members are advised to allow for a "moment of silence" upon entry into the general search area, by stopping all movement, work activity and reducing breathing/air bottle sounds. This silence will allow for ACTIVE LISTENING for PASS (Personal Alert Safety System) device alarms, audible sounds from injured/trapped fire fighters, or possible radio noises/squelch coming from trapped

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members. Frequently the trapped/lost member can be located immediately by these telltale sounds when rescuers take a moment to actually listen for them.

11. Fire Fighter Basic Self-Survival Procedures

- a. The rescue of lost, trapped or injured firefighters is especially time sensitive. There is a very narrow "window of survivability" for a firefighter who is out of SCBA air supply or trapped by approaching fire. Individual firefighters must not delay reporting "Firefighter Down" if they become lost, trapped or in need of emergency assistance.
- b. Company Officers must also not delay the reporting of lost firefighters (or inability to account for personnel) through a PAR Incident Commanders and other overhead must always assume that the missing firefighter is lost in the hazard area until he or she can be accounted for.
- c. Call For Help Immediately. Firefighters who find themselves lost, trapped or injured must immediately follow the "Firefighter Down" procedures previously outlined while they continue to attempt to find their way out. Firefighters should not delay notification of distress. Notification should occur as soon as the firefighter THINKS he or she is in trouble and before attempting to actually exit.
- d. Other Radio Channel
 - i. If a lost, trapped or injured firefighter cannot make radio contact on either the Command or Tactical channel, the firefighter should go to another channel (local net) to attempt contact and declare an emergency. It is important to find any channel that works.
- e. Activate PASS Device
 - i. As soon as a firefighter recognizes he/she is lost or trapped, the PASS device must be manually activated to sound the audible tone. The device must remain on until rescued. If the device interferes with the lost firefighters communicating critical radio messages to the incident commander or rescuers, the device may be turned off temporarily. Once messages are completed, the device must again be manually activated.
- f. Crews Stay Together
 - i. Members that separate from each other make it difficult for rescuers to find all firefighters. Crewmembers that stay intact as a crew enhance their chances for ALL being rescued and allow easier, more efficient extrication.
 - ii. Follow the Hose or Tag Line Out
 - iii. Crewmembers should stay with the hose line (or tag line) and follow it out whenever possible. All firefighters must remember that the female sides of the couplings are toward the nozzle (the fire), male side of the couplings toward the pump (outside). The hose line should always be treated as a safety line to the outside. Where tag line ropes are in use, follow the tag line to the exterior.

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- iv. Searching for an exit a lost firefighter should always attempt to get out of the hazard area by whatever means possible. This would include actually breaching walls when possible.

Where doors, windows, or other egress is not available, firefighters should next attempt to reach an exterior wall. Once at the wall he/she will be able to search for doorways, windows, and hallways that generally lead to the outside. Rescuers will first search hallways, around walls, and around windows and doors, before sweeping large interior areas. These actions will provide predictable activities that will aid both rescuers and lost firefighters.

- v. Retreat to a Safe Refuge.

- 1. Where the firefighter cannot find a way out, but there is a safe refuge (protective room or floor) away from the fire that the firefighter can retreat to, he/she should take advantage of this location. Command and the rescuers should then be advised of the location by whatever means possible.

- vi. Stay Calm and Conserve Air

- 1. A conscious effort must be made by the lost firefighter to control breathing. Unnecessary talking or physical activity must be ceased. Firefighters must control and pace their physical exertion activities in order to extend their SCBA air supply.

- vii. SCBA Face piece Filter

- 1. If the SCBA air supply is depleted, the firefighter may use the protective hood or other article of safety clothing as a filter of toxic atmospheres. The filter may be placed in or over the face piece's open inhalation valve attachment area, or over the opening of the disconnected low-pressure hose.

- viii. Horizontal Position

- 1. If a firefighter cannot get out he/she should assume a horizontal position on the floor that maximizes the audible affects of the PASS device. The firefighter should attempt to take this position at an exterior wall, doorway or hallway that maximizes quick discovery by rescue crews.

- ix. Flashlights/Tapping Noise

- 1. If assuming a position to await rescuers the firefighter(s) should attempt to position his/her flashlight toward the ceiling. This will enhance the rescuer's ability to see the light and locate the downed firefighter. If able, the firefighter should attempt tapping noises to assist rescuers in locating him/her (i.e. hitting a tool against a metal roll-up door).

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12. Definitions

- a. *Company Unity*: A term to indicate that a fire company or assigned crew will remain together in a cohesive, identifiable working group to ensure personnel accountability and the safety of all members. A company officer or crew leader will be responsible for the adequate supervision, control, communication and safety of members of the company or crew. (See also Unity of Command)
- b. *"Fire Fighter Down" condition*: A term given to any situation in which personnel are reported to be lost, trapped, seriously injured, or otherwise needing immediate assistance. Whenever anyone at the incident reports "Fire Fighter Down", Rapid Intervention Crew operations will immediately begin.
- c. *Full State of Readiness*: Personnel with full protective personal equipment, including SCBA/SABA/PASS, rescue ropes, entry tools, search I rescue equipment for specific hazards, radio and available hose lines. Personnel will stand by at the Command Post or other assigned location, monitoring radios and conditions of the incident being constantly ready to immediately begin search, rescue, extrication, and removal of lost, trapped, or injured fire fighters.
- d. *Immediately Dangerous to Life or Health (IDLH)*: An atmosphere or condition that poses an immediate threat to life, would cause irreversible adverse health effects, or would impair an individual's ability to escape from a dangerous situation. Conditions present during an advanced (beyond incipient stage) interior structural fire create an IDLH atmosphere. Other examples of IDLH conditions include, but are not limited to the following:
 - i. Fires and earthquake damage to pre-1933 brick construction
 - ii. Fires and earthquake damage to facades (supported and unsupported)
 - iii. Fires in lightweight construction
 - iv. Potential flashover and back draft conditions
 - v. Roof ventilation operations
 - vi. Fires in occupancies with large basements or large spaces where getting lost is a high potential
 - vii. Multiple fire attack teams working inside and on upper floors.
 - viii. High rise fires
 - ix. Refinery fires
 - x. Fires and other incidents in Metro Rail tunnels, mines and other subterranean locations
 - xi. Structural collapse from earthquakes, explosions, floods, wind, and other causes
 - xii. Confined Space Rescues
 - xiii. Trench Rescues
 - xiv. Swift Water Rescues
 - xv. High angle rescues
 - xvi. Hazardous Materials Incidents
 - xvii. Possible terrorism incidents

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- xviii. Any other incident type with a potential exposure to IDLH conditions.
- e. **Interior Structural Fire Fighting:** Refers to the physical activity of fire suppression rescue or both, inside of buildings or enclosed structures, which are involved in a situation beyond the incipient stage.
- f. **Operational Retreat:** An evacuation of all personnel operating in hazardous areas at an emergency incident. Its purpose is to remove crews to safety and to obtain an accurate Personnel Accountability Report (PAR) as a function of Personnel Accountability. Personnel operating in the hazardous area will be notified by an emergency radio transmission and a standard air horn signal.
- g. **Personnel Accountability System (PAS):** The term used to describe the Department's method of maintaining constant awareness of the identities and location of all personnel at an emergency incident. This Department utilizes the ICS principles of Company Unity and Unity of Command as the cornerstone of its Personnel Accountability System. The PAS is necessary to ensure that all personnel may be quickly located after an adverse event (i.e. Collapse or flashover), when an Operational Retreat is ordered, when a PAR is requested or when a "Fire Fighter Down" is reported.
- h. **Rapid Intervention Crew (RIC):** A term used to describe a group of at least two personnel (preferably one engine company and additional units as needed for specific hazards) who are assembled in a Full State of Readiness for rapid entry search and rescue of other members during an emergency incident. The RIC will have a designated RIC Supervisor, preferably an office Personnel assigned to a RIC will be fully equipped for the particular hazards that may be encountered, with protective personal equipment and appropriate search/rescue equipment. They will maintain constant awareness of the number and identity of members operating in the hazardous area, their location, assignment, and time of entry. This information will be relayed and recorded on the PAS Roster. The RIC should remain in a full state of Readiness, near the Command Post or location assigned by the Incident Commander. The conversion from standby crew to rapid intervention crew occurs upon the ordering of emergency resources beyond the 1st alarm.
- i. **Personnel Accountability Report (PAR):** A term to indicate the process of conducting a "roll call" of all personnel on an emergency incident. The PAR will be supervised by the Incident Commander and provide a rapid means of determining if all companies, units and individuals can be accounted for in a place of safety. On large-scale incidents all operational ICS positions will report the results of the PAR for their assigned resources to the member responsible for the PAS Roster for rapid transmittal to the Incident Commander. If any members are unaccounted for, the PAR will be repeated, and/or runners sent to verify the status of unreported personnel. RIC operations will be initiated as necessary.
- j. **Standby, Standby Crew, Standby Member:** A reference to two members I personnel who remain outside the hazard area throughout incident. The standby

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members are responsible for maintaining a constant awareness of the number and identity of members operating in the hazardous area, their location, assignment, and time of entry. The information will be relayed and recorded on the PAS Roster. The standby members will remain in radio; visual or signal line communications with the entry crew. One standby member will be permitted to perform other duties outside of the hazardous area, such as apparatus operator, incident commander, or technician or aide, provided constant communication is maintained between the standby members and members of the entry crew. The other standby member will be solely assigned to monitor and track interior personnel using the PAS Roster. Full protective clothing, protective equipment and SCBA will be donned by the standby crew in preparation of possible rescue activities of down, trapped or injured personnel inside the hazard area. The standby crew will notify the Incident Commander or Unit ECC of their impending entry, prior to entering the hazard area.

- k. *Technical Rescue Company*: Refers to an equipped vehicle and trained personnel that meet OES guidelines for Urban Search and Rescue Medium Operational Response Capability or higher. Medium Operational Level represents the minimum capability to conduct safe and effective search and rescue operations at structure collapse incidents involving the collapse or failure of reinforced and unreinforced masonry (URM), concrete tilt-up, and heavy timber construction.
- l. *Unity of Command*: The concept that every individual within an organization reports to one and only one designated supervisor. This principle is intended to clarify reporting relationships and eliminate the confusion caused by conflicting directives.